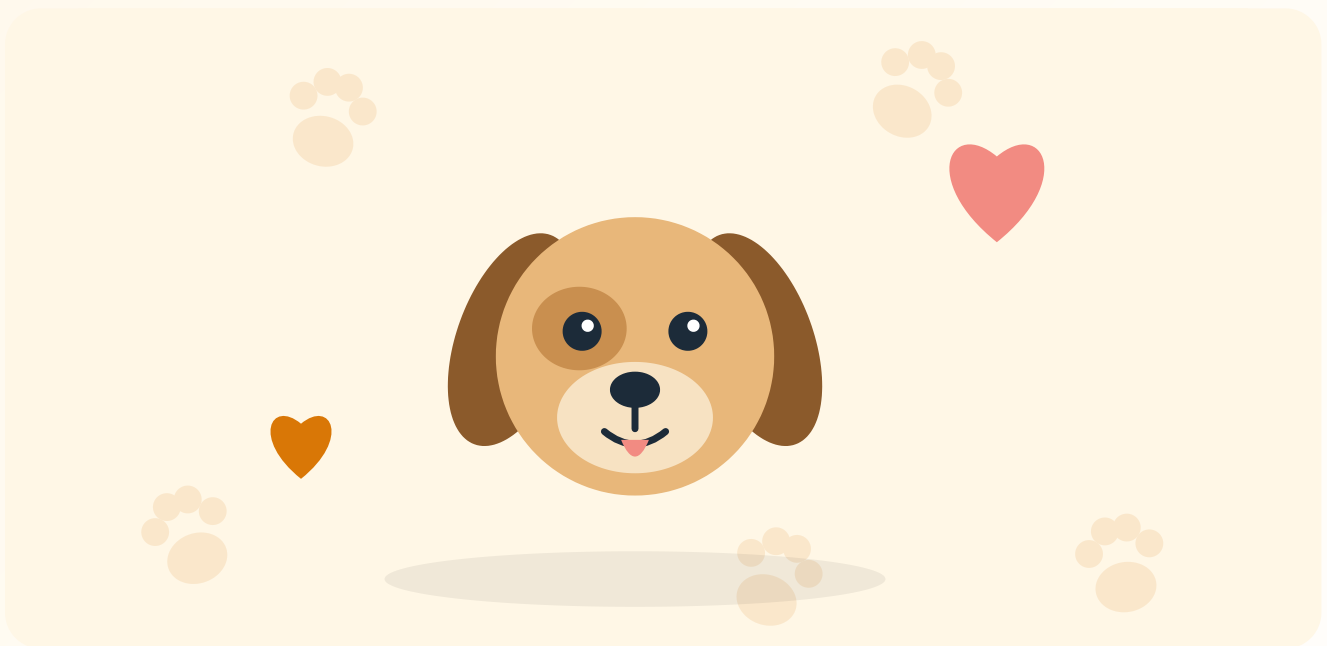


PUPPY PANIC

The New Puppy Owner Survival Guide

A complete beginner handbook for raising a happier, calmer and better-trained dog.



16 chapters · step-by-step training · printable worksheets

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Welcome To Puppy Parenthood

Congratulations on welcoming a new puppy into your life. The first weeks are important because your puppy is learning about your home, your routine and your expectations. Everything they experience now shapes the adult dog they will become.

Many puppy behaviours that frustrate owners, like biting, crying at night and chewing, are normal parts of development. They are not signs that something is wrong with your puppy or with you. With patience, consistency and the right guidance, you can turn each of them into a learning moment.

The Three Golden Rules

Reward what you like

Behaviour that gets rewarded gets repeated. Catch your puppy doing something right and pay them for it.

Manage what you don't

Prevent mistakes before they happen with gates, crates, lead and supervision.

Keep it short

Three 5-minute sessions beat one 30-minute session. End while your puppy still wants more.

Stay calm

Puppies read your mood. A calm owner raises a calm dog. Shouting only teaches them to fear you.

How To Use This Guide

Read the chapters in order during your first week, then keep the guide handy for the problem-solving pages. Print the worksheets at the back and stick them on your fridge so the whole household follows the same plan.

The Puppy Panic Promise:

Help owners understand their dogs, create better habits and enjoy the journey.

Preparing Your Home

Get everything ready before your puppy arrives so the first day is about bonding, not shopping.

Shopping Checklist

- ☐ Crate or pen, big enough to stand up and turn around in
- ☐ Soft bed and a blanket that smells of their litter (ask the breeder)
- ☐ Food and water bowls
- ☐ The same puppy food they are already eating
- ☐ Small, soft training treats
- ☐ 3-4 chew toys of different textures
- ☐ Collar with ID tag, plus a lightweight lead
- ☐ Enzyme cleaner for accidents
- ☐ Baby gates for rooms that are off-limits

Puppy-Proof Room By Room

Living room

Lift cables out of reach, move plants, and put remote controls and shoes away.

Kitchen

Lock bins and cleaning products away. Keep food off low surfaces.

Bathroom

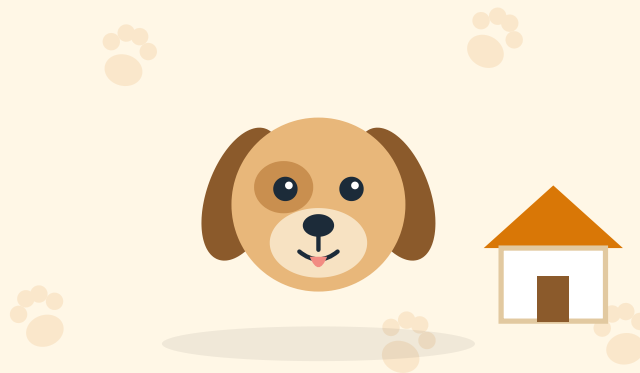
Keep the toilet lid down and medicines stored high.

Garden

Check fences for gaps and remove toxic plants and slug pellets.

Tip: Get down on your hands and knees and look around. Anything you can reach at puppy height, your puppy will find.

The First 48 Hours



A quiet, cosy base helps your puppy settle in.

Arrival Day

- 1 Take your puppy straight to their toilet spot outside and wait. Praise them quietly when they go.
- 2 Let them explore one or two rooms at their own pace. Keep visitors away for the first few days.
- 3 Show them their bed and water bowl, then let them nap as much as they want. Puppies sleep 18-20 hours a day.
- 4 Start using their name in a happy voice whenever you feed, play or cuddle them.

The First Night

Your puppy has just left their mother and littermates, so some crying is normal. Place their crate or bed next to your bed for the first nights so they can hear and smell you. A warm (not hot) water bottle wrapped in a towel and a ticking clock can be comforting. Expect one or two toilet trips during the night for the first weeks.

Understanding Puppy Behaviour

Why Puppies Bite

Puppies explore the world with their mouths, and they learned to play by biting their littermates. Teething between about 3 and 6 months makes it worse. The goal is not punishment. The goal is teaching your puppy what they can bite instead.

Why Puppies Chew

Chewing relieves teething pain, burns energy and calms puppies down. You cannot stop it, but you can direct it. Keep two or three chew toys in every room and swap anything they should not have for something they can have.

The Zoomies

Sudden bursts of wild running, usually in the evening, are a normal way to release energy. Make sure the space is safe and let them run it out. Frequent zoomies can mean your puppy is overtired and needs a nap.

Reading Your Puppy's Body Language

What you see	What it usually means
Loose, wiggly body and soft eyes	Relaxed and happy
Play bow (front down, bottom up)	Invitation to play
Yawning, lip licking, looking away	Unsure or stressed; give them space
Tail tucked, ears flat, body low	Frightened; remove them from the situation
Stiff body, hard stare, freezing	Uncomfortable; stop what is happening

Toilet Training Made Simple

Toilet training is about timing. The more often your puppy goes in the right place and gets rewarded, the faster they learn. Most puppies are reliable by 4-6 months.

Take Your Puppy Out

After waking

From every nap as well as first thing in the morning.

After eating

Usually within 15-30 minutes of a meal.

After play

Excitement fills the bladder fast.

Every 1-2 hours

A rough guide: puppies can hold on for about their age in months plus one, in hours.

The Routine

- 1 Go to the same spot every time, on lead, and stand still.
- 2 Say a cue word such as "be quick" while they sniff.
- 3 The moment they finish, praise and give a treat right there.
- 4 If nothing happens within 5 minutes, go back in, watch them closely and try again in 10 minutes.

When Accidents Happen

✓ Do

- Calmly pick them up and take them outside
- Clean with an enzyme cleaner to remove the smell
- Go out more often for a few days

✗ Avoid

- Shouting or rubbing their nose in it
- Using ammonia-based cleaners, which smell like urine
- Punishing an accident you did not see happen

Puppy Training Foundations

Puppies can start learning the day they come home. Use food, toys and praise to show them what you want, and keep every session short and fun.

Name Recognition

- 1 Say your puppy's name once in a happy voice.
- 2 The moment they look at you, say "yes!" and give a treat.
- 3 Repeat 10 times, a few times a day, in different rooms.

Sit

- 1 Hold a treat at your puppy's nose.
- 2 Slowly move it up and back over their head. As their head goes up, their bottom goes down.
- 3 The moment they sit, say "yes!" and give the treat.
- 4 Once they follow the treat every time, say "sit" just before you move your hand.

Come

- 1 Start indoors, a few steps away. Crouch down and call their name followed by "come!" in an exciting voice.
- 2 Reward with something extra special every time they reach you.
- 3 Slowly increase the distance, then practise in the garden.

Never call your puppy to you for something they dislike, like a bath or the end of play. Coming to you should always be the best decision they make.

Stay, Leave It And Settle

Stay

- 1 Ask for a sit. Show a flat palm and say "stay".
- 2 Wait one second, then say "yes!" and reward while they are still sitting.
- 3 Build up slowly: 2 seconds, 5 seconds, 10 seconds.
- 4 Only then add distance: one step back, return, reward.

Leave It

- 1 Hold a treat in a closed fist. Let your puppy sniff and lick.
- 2 Wait. The moment they back off or look away, say "yes!" and reward from your other hand.
- 3 When they back off straight away, add the words "leave it".
- 4 Progress to a treat on the floor, covered by your hand if needed.

Settle On A Mat

- 1 Sit on a chair with your puppy on lead and a mat or blanket on the floor.
- 2 Ignore them and reward calmly whenever they lie down on the mat.
- 3 Over a few days, reward longer and more relaxed settles.

Short daily training sessions are more effective than long frustrating sessions. Aim for 3-5 minutes, 3 times a day.

Socialisation: The Window That Matters

Between about 3 and 14 weeks old, puppies accept new experiences easily. What they meet calmly now, they are less likely to fear later. Aim for lots of short, positive introductions. Ask your vet when it is safe for your puppy to walk in public places and meet other dogs; until then, carry them and invite people over.

Socialisation Checklist

- ☐ People: men, women, children, people in hats, beards, uniforms
- ☐ Sounds: vacuum, doorbell, washing machine, traffic, fireworks recordings
- ☐ Surfaces: grass, gravel, tiles, wet ground, metal grates
- ☐ Handling: paws, ears, mouth, brushing, nail trims
- ☐ Places: car rides, a café, the vet's waiting room (just for treats)
- ☐ Animals: a calm, vaccinated adult dog, cats if you have them
- ☐ Things: umbrellas, bikes, pushchairs, wheelie bins

✓ Do

- Let your puppy approach in their own time
- Pair every new thing with treats
- Keep introductions short and end on a good note

✗ Avoid

- Forcing them towards something scary
- Crowds of strangers all at once
- Rough play with unknown dogs

Your Puppy's First 30 Days

Week 1: Settle In

- Build trust with calm handling and lots of sleep
- Set a toilet routine and mealtimes
- Teach name recognition
- Introduce the crate or pen with meals and treats

Week 2: Build Habits

- Start sit and the first steps of come
- Practise short periods alone (a few minutes in another room)
- Begin handling practice: paws, ears, collar

Week 3: Grow Confidence

- Add stay and leave it
- Introduce new sounds, surfaces and visitors
- Try the first brain games from this guide

Week 4: Practise Everywhere

- Repeat every command in new rooms and the garden
- Work on settle while you eat or watch TV
- Review your progress tracker and pick your next goal

Every puppy learns at their own speed. If you fall behind, simply repeat the week. Consistency matters more than speed.

Solving Common Problems

Crying At Night

- Keep your puppy close to you for the first nights
- Tire them out with play and a toilet trip before bed
- Give a quiet toilet break if they wake, then straight back to bed
- Move the crate further away gradually over a few weeks

Biting Hands

- When teeth touch skin, say "oops", stop play for a few seconds
- Offer a tug toy or chew instead
- If they are overexcited, it is usually nap time

Jumping Up

- Turn away and ignore jumping
- Reward the moment all four paws are on the floor
- Ask visitors to do the same so the rule is consistent

Chewing Furniture

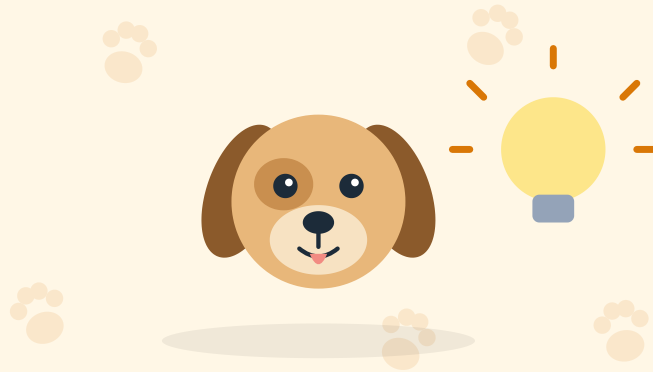
- Supervise, or use a pen when you cannot watch
- Swap the item for a chew toy and praise
- Offer frozen chews during teething

Pulling On The Lead

- Stop walking whenever the lead goes tight
- Move forward again when it goes slack
- Reward them for walking by your side

Brain Training For Dogs

Dogs need mental exercise as well as physical exercise. Ten minutes of brain work can tire a puppy as much as a walk, and it builds focus, confidence and problem-solving.



A tired brain is a calm puppy.

Five Games To Try This Week

Find it

Toss a treat a short way and say "find it". Then hide treats around the room for them to sniff out.

Cup game

Hide a treat under one of three cups and let your puppy choose. Reward correct guesses.

Muffin tin puzzle

Put treats in a muffin tin and cover each one with a tennis ball.

Snuffle towel

Roll treats inside an old towel and let them unroll it.

Touch

Teach them to nose-touch your palm. It becomes a handy way to move your puppy anywhere.

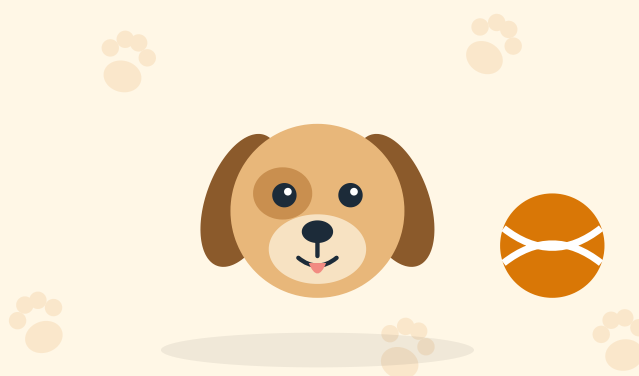
Name the toy

Say a toy's name each time you play with it. Soon they can fetch it by name.

Bonus: 7-Day Puppy Training Challenge

Five to ten minutes a day. Tick each day off as you go.

Day	Focus	Done
1	Name game: say their name, reward eye contact	
2	Sit: lure with a treat, reward the moment they sit	
3	Handling: gently touch paws and ears, reward calm	
4	Come: short recalls indoors, big rewards	
5	Leave it: reward looking away from a treat in your hand	
6	Settle: reward lying calmly on their bed	
7	Review: practise every skill in a new room	



Small wins every day add up fast.

Finished the week? Start again, this time practising in the garden or with a friend watching.

Bonus: Daily Puppy Schedule

Here is a sample day for a puppy of 8-12 weeks. Adjust the times to fit your home. Consistency is what matters most.

Time	Activity	Your time
7:00	Wake up + toilet break	
7:15	Breakfast, then toilet break	
7:45	Play and a 5-minute training session	
8:30	Nap in crate or pen	
10:30	Toilet break + explore the garden	
12:00	Lunch, toilet break, then nap	
15:00	Brain game + toilet break	
17:00	Dinner, then toilet break	
18:00	Family time and handling practice	
20:00	Calm wind-down with a chew	
22:00	Last toilet break + bed	

Add a toilet break after every nap, meal and play session, plus once or twice at night for the first few weeks.

My Puppy Profile

Fill this in and keep it somewhere handy, such as on the fridge.

Name	
Breed	
Date of birth	
Date they came home	
Favourite treat	
Favourite toy	
Vet name + phone	
Next vaccination	
Microchip number	
My #1 training goal	



Stick your favourite photo of your puppy here.

My Puppy Progress Tracker

Score each skill every week: 1 = just started, 2 = getting there, 3 = does it every time.

Skill	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4
Name				
Sit				
Come				
Stay				
Leave It				
Settle				
Toilet outside				
Loose lead				
Calm greetings				
Alone time				

Notes

Continue Your Training Journey

You now have the foundations: a routine, first commands and a plan for the most common problems. The next step is to keep your puppy's brain busy as they grow.

For owners who want a structured approach with progressive exercises, explore Brain Training For Dogs. It builds on the games in this guide with step-by-step lessons for focus, impulse control and obedience.

Explore Brain Training For Dogs

A guided training system for developing focus, engagement and learning.

[Start Training Your Dog](#)



Keep learning together.

Disclosure: Puppy Panic may earn a commission if you purchase through this link at no extra cost to you. This guide is general information and not a substitute for advice from your vet.

PUPPY PANIC

Your Puppy Journey Starts Today

Every great dog begins with patience, consistency and love.

